



IT IS WELL AFTER 9 PM, and Mohit Joshi has had a long day. His company, Tech Mahindra, has just declared its quarterly numbers, and he has a flight to Singapore the next day. Based in London, Joshi is described by his employer as a “road warrior” and has a hectic travel schedule worldwide.

As he settles into a hotel meeting room near Mumbai’s international airport for a working dinner, Joshi, the company’s CEO & MD, is chatty. He fields questions on challenges for the \$6.5-billion Tech Mahindra, an IT services and solutions company that has been around for over three decades, and his optimism about artificial intelligence (AI). He is acutely aware of the advantage of being part of a conglomerate and will use that strategically. At the same time, there is pressure to increase margins to keep up with its rivals. By any yardstick, these are difficult times to be in the IT business. But Tech Mahindra could find them most interesting if it gets a few things right and executes them well.

MOVING IN

Joshi is no stranger to impressive growth. When he joined Infosys in late 2000, it was a \$180-million company; when he quit as President in mid-2023, its turnover was \$18 billion. When Tech Mahindra’s offer came, Joshi believed it was the right size at \$6.5 billion. “With

150,000 people, it was large enough to have a global impact. It had a good mix of service lines, industries, and geographies,” says Joshi.

The soft-spoken Joshi, a history graduate with an MBA, plays down his recruitment as very straightforward. C.P. Gurnani was due to retire after 19 years at Tech Mahindra’s helm, and global executive search firm Spencer Stuart was mandated to look for candidates within and outside the organisation. “There was a grand total of two discussions before I was picked. I liked the client base, talent, and the group,” says Joshi.

He is clear about ensuring continuity. “This is not a transition, and we did not have to come in to rescue the company... The task was to manage clients and chart a course for where we want to be two or three years from now,” Joshi explains. And he is not rushing to build his team (“90% is the old team,” he says). His playbook: build a business on strong fundamentals and get the best out of the team and brand. Richard Lobo, the company’s Chief People Officer, is clear that the change is merely a part of the firm’s journey and that the employees have welcomed it.

“There is deep talent in the team and we want to write the next chapter of Tech Mahindra,” says Joshi. Tech Mahindra was born as Mahindra British Telecom in the 1980s, body-shopping for British Telecom before graduating to the offshore model. Its first milestone was the merger of Satyam Computer Services with itself in 2012 after Satyam’s founder almost sank the company with accounting jugglery and it was put on the auction block. The British Telecom link (which ended in 2012) gave Tech Mahindra domain leadership, while the Satyam acquisition catapulted it into the big league.

MAKING SIZE WORK

Barring Tata Consultancy Services, none of Tech Mahindra’s rivals has the advantage of being part of a diverse group. Tech Mahindra is part of the \$21-billion

AT A GLANCE



Tech Mahindra was set up in 1986 and was then known as Mahindra British Telecom



A big moment was the buyout of troubled Satyam in 2009 before the two companies merged in 2012